

Q. Who is best suited to be the next prime minister of India?

NARENDRA MODI	48.7
RAHUL GANDHI	27.1
C. JOSEPH VIJAY	9.2
MAMATA BANERJEE	2
AKHILESH YADAV	1.7
ABHIJIT DIPKE	1.3
ARVIND KEJRIWAL	1.2

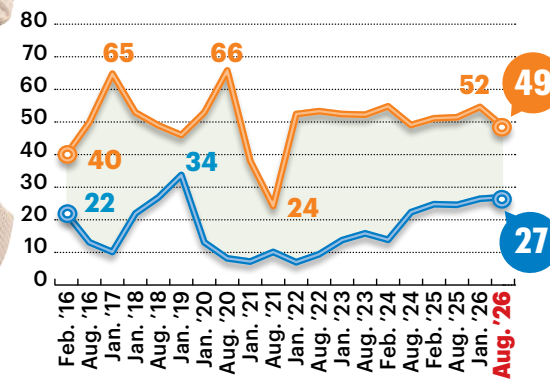
Though a lesser share of respondents favour PM Modi's leadership, he retains a healthy lead over others



Photographs by CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

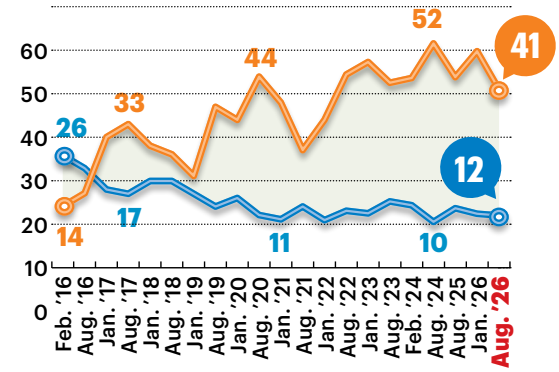
NARENDRA MODI vs RAHUL GANDHI

How MOTN surveys have reflected the public mood on the choice of PM candidate between the two leaders



NARENDRA MODI vs INDIRA GANDHI

The popularity trends of two Indian prime ministers known for their bold moves across MOTN polls



All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

The gap between Modi's popularity and that of Rahul remains a high 22 percentage points. The Congress leader has not gained traction despite a dip in the PM's ratings

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP). AAP has since left the bloc. To add to INDIA's woes, M.K. Stalin's Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) lost the Tamil Nadu assembly election in May and subsequently pulled out of the alliance in pique after the Congress lent its support to Vijay's ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK).

For a change, it is the Congress that has shored up INDIA's numbers. Its tally has risen from 80 seats in the January MOTN to 106 now, a gain of 26 seats and seven more than the 99 it secured in